CASE STUDY · PLAYER VALUATION REPORT · 2025-26 SEASON

Eli Junior Kroupi

Forward · AFC Bournemouth · Age 20

Performance and salary value analysis

13

Premier League goals in 1,708 minutes

3rd

in the Premier League for non-penalty goals per 90 minutes

£25k

estimated current weekly salary

£48–79k

justified salary according to our machine learning model

Study based on public data (Understat, SalaryLeaks)

Prepared by Mathis Maitrallin · Data & AI · September 2026

Key findings at a glance

PLAYER PROFILE

An elite finisher

13 goals from 8.8 xG in 1,708 minutes: 3rd in the Premier League for non-penalty goals per 90 minutes, behind Haaland and Sesko.

The player who outperforms his xG the most in the league. He was already doing so at 18 at Lorient (5 goals from 4.2 xG in Ligue 1 in 2023-24).

6 goals against the Big Six and 4 goals off the bench, joint-best in the league.

Area for improvement: chance creation, with no assists all season.

SCENARIO 1 · STAYING AT BOURNEMOUTH

A pay rise is justified

£25,000 a week: 83rd-highest salary out of 85 Premier League forwards, despite ranking 3rd for goals per 90 minutes.

Bournemouth's top scorer, but only the 22nd-highest salary in a squad of 28.

Our model puts his fair salary between £48,000 (comparable profile) and £79,000 (equal performance).

Suggested negotiation range: £50,000 to £80,000, in line with the club's benchmarks (Rayan and the median salary at £50,000, Evanilson and Kluivert at £80,000).

SCENARIO 2 · JOINING BARÇA OR PSG

A profile both clubs are missing

At Barça: the finisher lost this summer with the departures of Lewandowski and Ferran Torres. 2nd for goals per 90 minutes behind Raphinha.

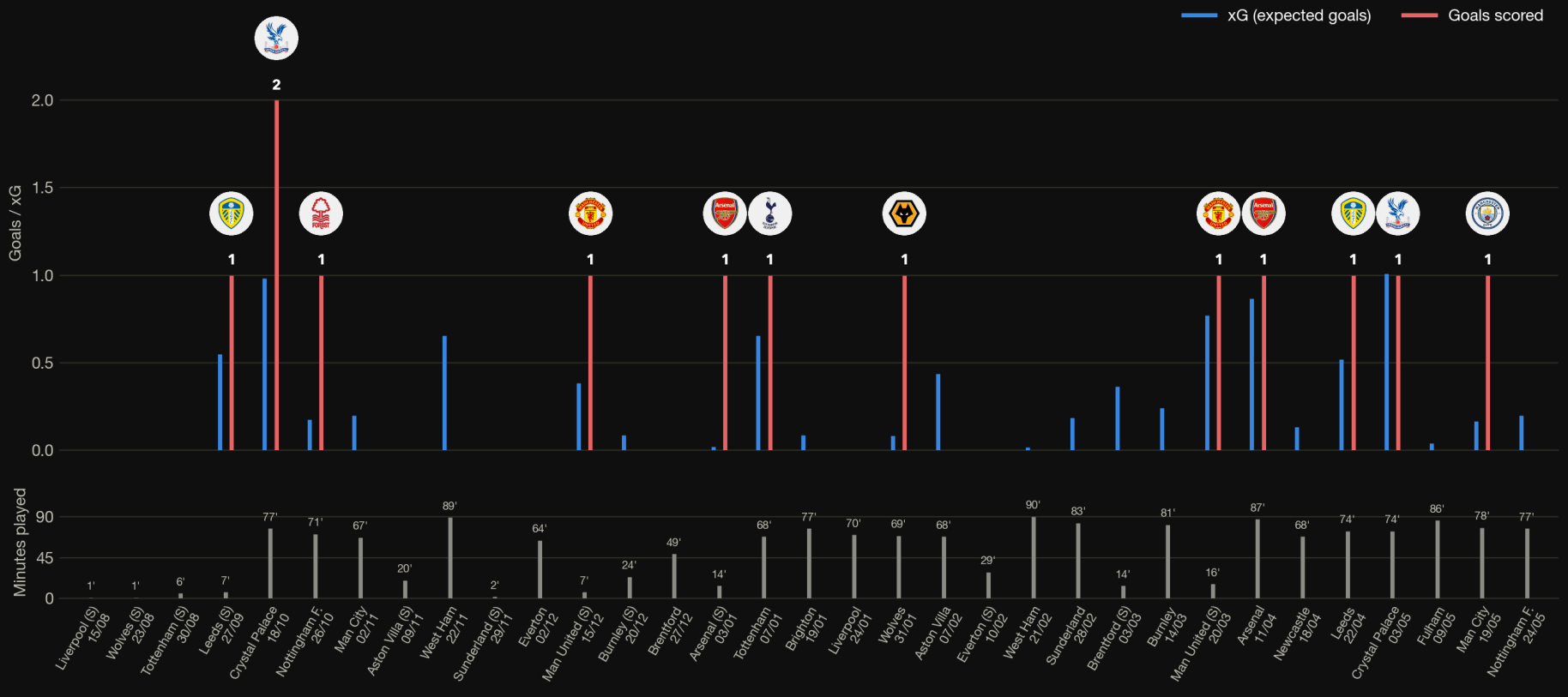
At PSG: a second option up front behind Ferran Torres, complementing creators Dembélé, Kvaratskhelia and Doué.

Adaptation: a very different, possession-based style, but the same intense pressing as at Bournemouth.

Estimated salary on a 5-year contract: £68,000 to £131,000 a week, while remaining the lowest-paid forward in the squad.

Eli Junior Kroupi scores more than his chances predict

Goals scored and xG, match by match — 2025-26 Premier League with Bournemouth. Total: 13 goals from 8.8 xG.



(S) = came on as a substitute. Source: Understat.

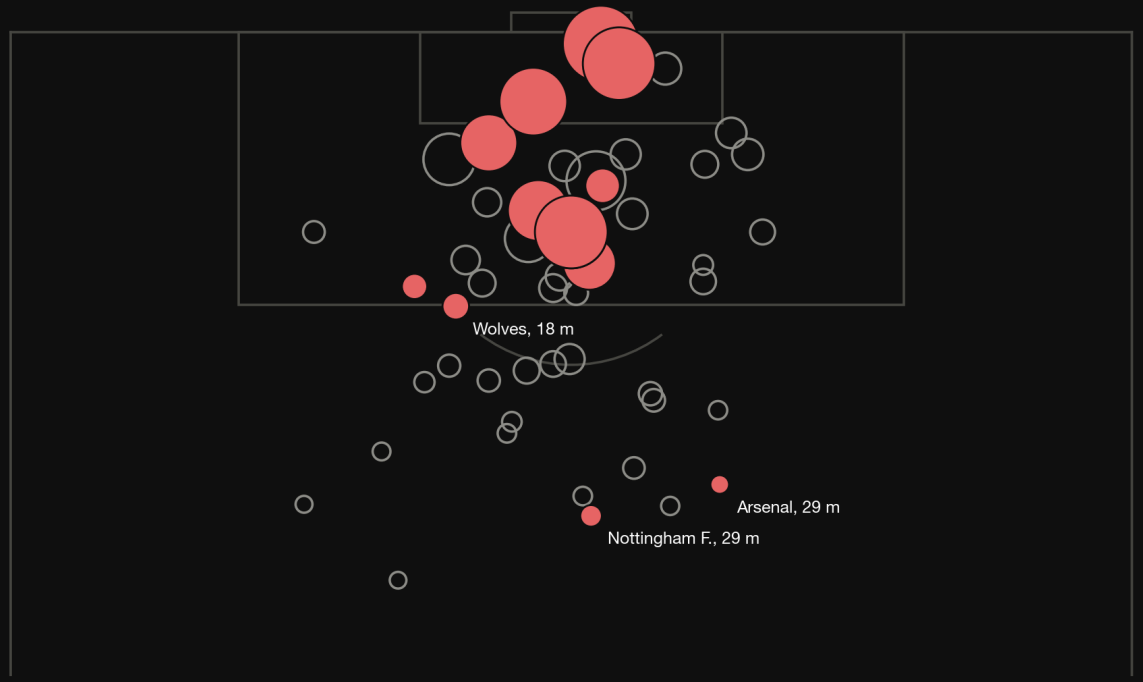
01

Goals and xG match by match

Kroupi scored 13 goals from 8.8 xG, around 4 more than his chances suggested. He does not pad his numbers against weaker sides: almost half of his goals (6 of 13) came against the Big Six (Arsenal twice, Manchester United twice, Manchester City and Tottenham). He can also make an impact very quickly: he scored against Leeds and Manchester United after just 7 minutes on the pitch, and against Arsenal within 14 minutes.

A finisher who punishes from close range and from distance

All 52 of Kroupi's shots in the 2025-26 Premier League. Dot size reflects the quality of the chance (xG).



52 shots

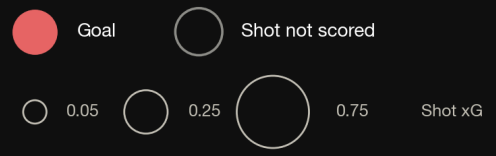
13 goals, 3 from outside the box

8.8 total xG

25% shot conversion rate

62% of shots taken inside the box

17 m average shot distance



Penalties included (2 taken, 2 scored). Source: Understat.

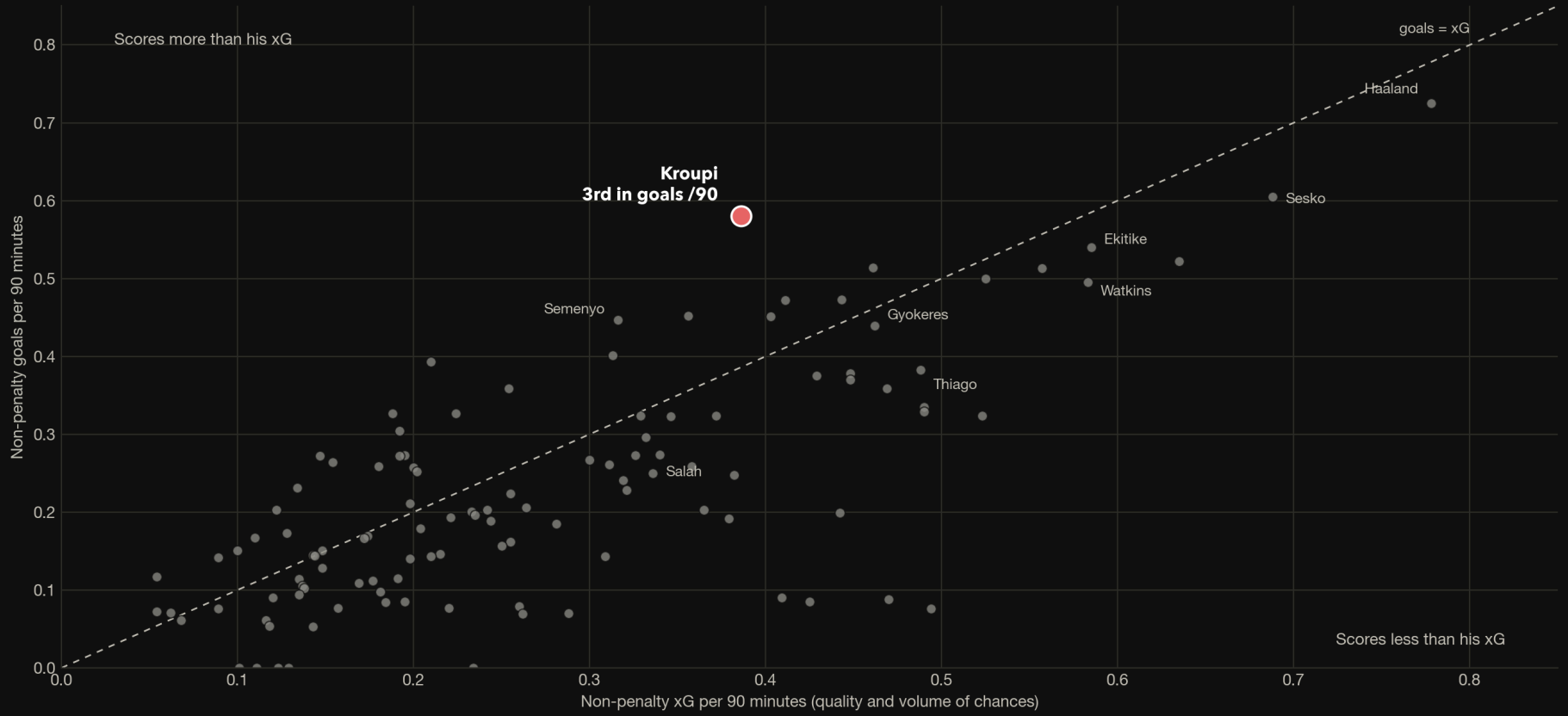
02

Shot map

Kroupi converted 25% of his shots (13 of 52). Most of his goals come from the danger zone between the penalty spot and the goal, but he can also score from distance: three goals from outside the box, including two strikes from almost 30 metres against Arsenal and Nottingham Forest. Area to work on: 38% of his shots are taken from outside the box, often low-value chances. In a team that gets the ball into the box more often, he would have more clear-cut chances.

One of the most clinical forwards in the Premier League

Non-penalty goals and xG per 90 minutes — 113 forwards and attacking midfielders, 2025-26 Premier League (900 minutes minimum). No one outperforms his xG more than Kroupi.



Source: Understat.

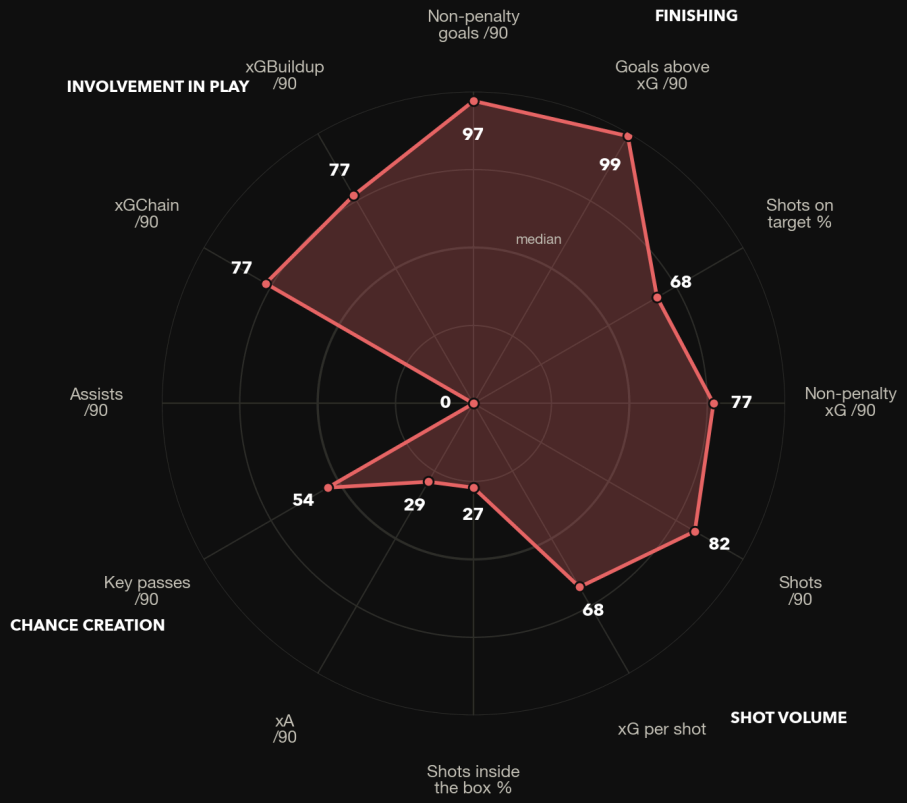
03

Goals vs. xG per 90 minutes

Each dot is a Premier League forward or attacking midfielder (900 minutes minimum). The further a player sits above the diagonal, the more he scores beyond what his chances suggest. Kroupi ranks 3rd in the league for non-penalty goals per 90 minutes, behind Haaland and Sesko, and no one outperforms his xG by more. Yet he gets fewer chances than the centre-forwards of the big clubs, who sit further to the right. In a team that creates more for him, his output could rise even further.

An elite finisher, still rarely involved in chance creation

Kroupi's percentiles against the 113 forwards and attacking midfielders of the 2025-26 Premier League (900 minutes minimum). 90 = better than 90% of them.



xGChain: xG of the possessions he is involved in. xGBuildup: the same, excluding shots and assists. Source: Understat.

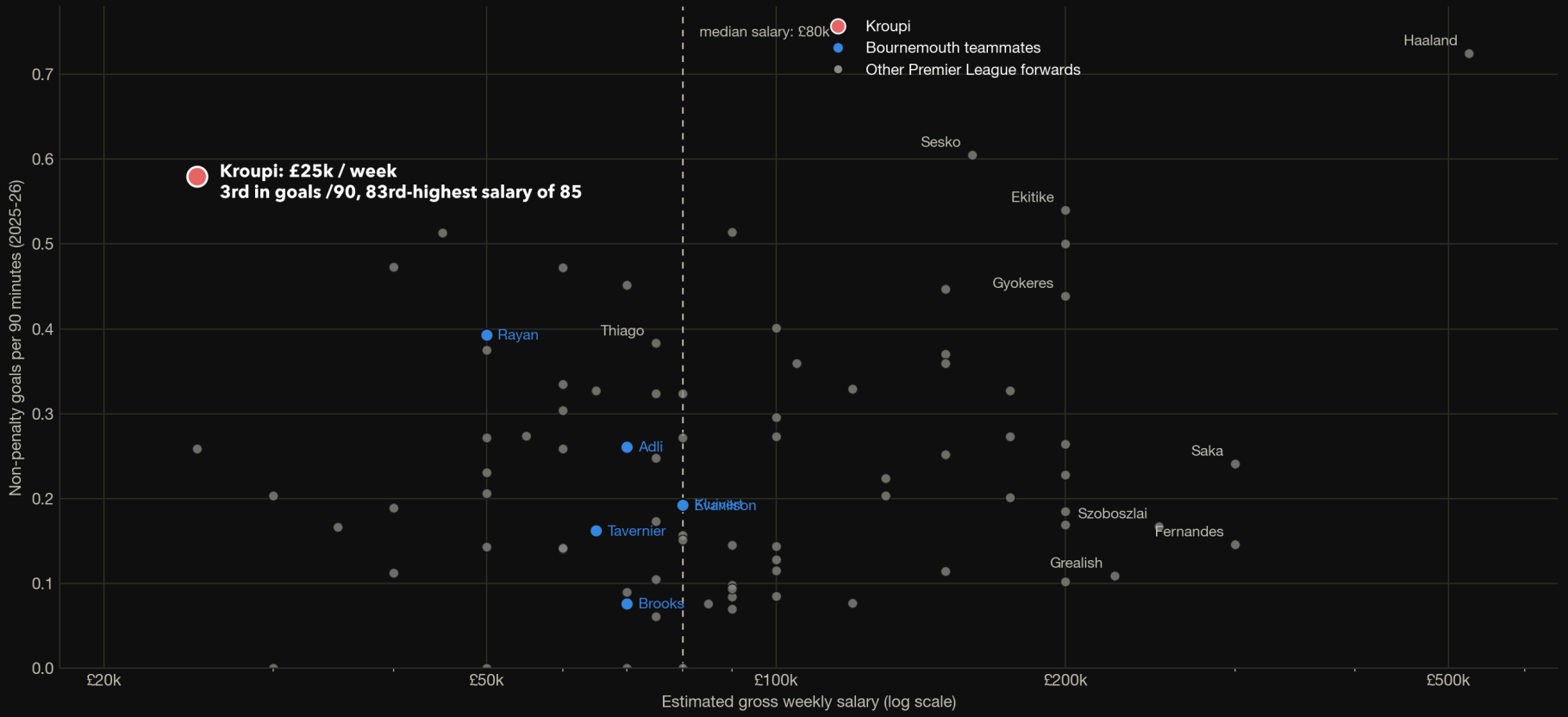
04

Percentile radar profile

Kroupi's profile is that of a finisher. He does better than 97% of Premier League forwards and attacking midfielders for goals per 90 minutes, and better than 99% of them for goals scored above his xG. He shoots often (82nd percentile) and is well involved in his team's attacking play (77th percentile for xGChain). His room for improvement lies in chance creation: no assists all season and few chances created for his teammates (29th percentile for xA). At his age, this is a normal area to develop and does not undermine his value as a goalscorer.

One of the league's best scorers, and one of its lowest paid

Current salary and non-penalty goals per 90 minutes — 85 Premier League forwards and attacking midfielders. 80 of the 82 players paid more than him score less.



Salaries: SalaryLeaks estimates (September 2026), players still in the Premier League. Stats: Understat, 900 minutes minimum.

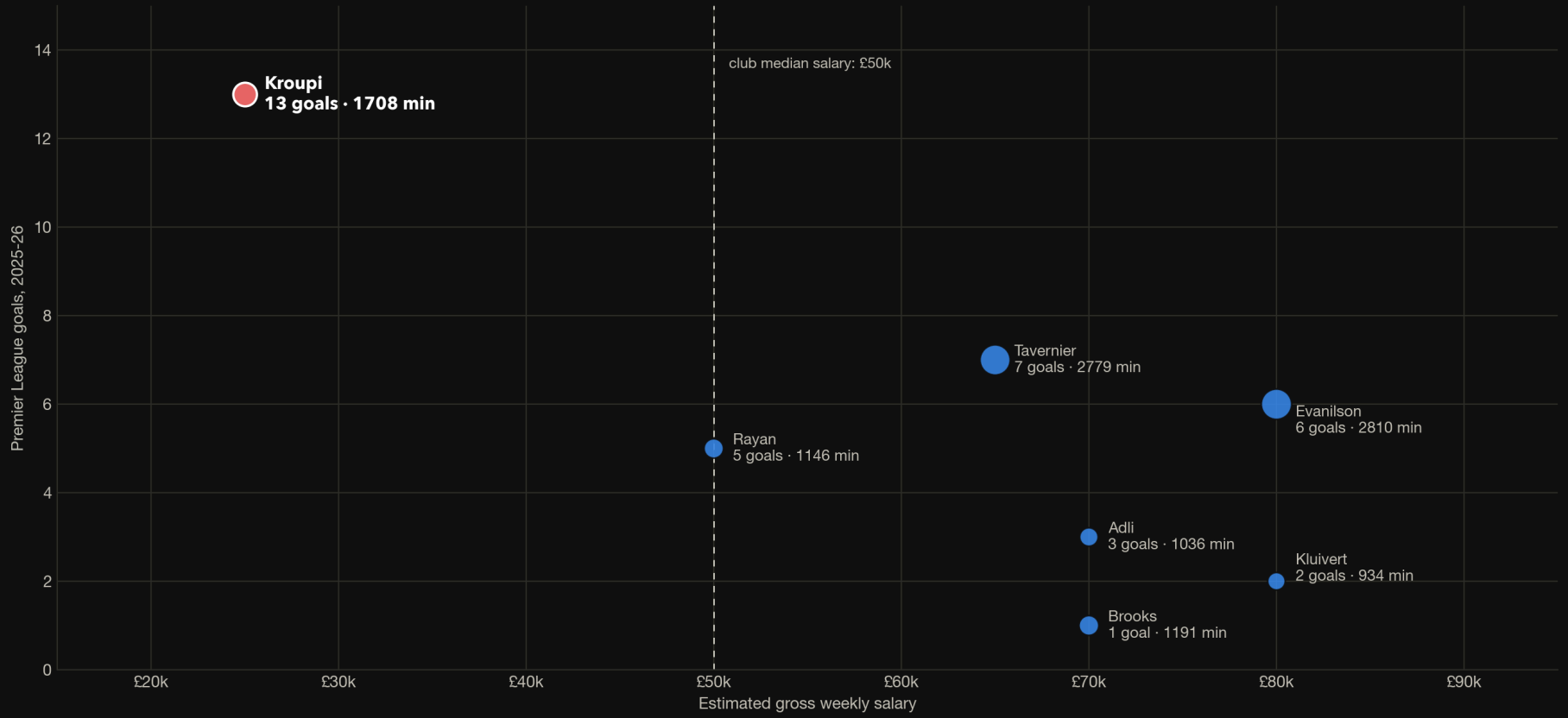
05

Salary and goals in the Premier League

With an estimated salary of £25,000 a week, Kroupi has the 83rd-highest salary among the 85 Premier League forwards and attacking midfielders studied, while ranking 3rd for non-penalty goals per 90 minutes. 80 of the 82 players paid more than him score less. The median salary in this group is £80,000 a week, more than three times his.

Bournemouth's top scorer, only the 22nd-highest salary at the club

Current salary and goals of Bournemouth's forwards and attacking midfielders (450 minutes minimum). Dot size = minutes played. Squad of 28 players.



Salaries: SalaryLeaks estimates (September 2026). Stats: Understat.

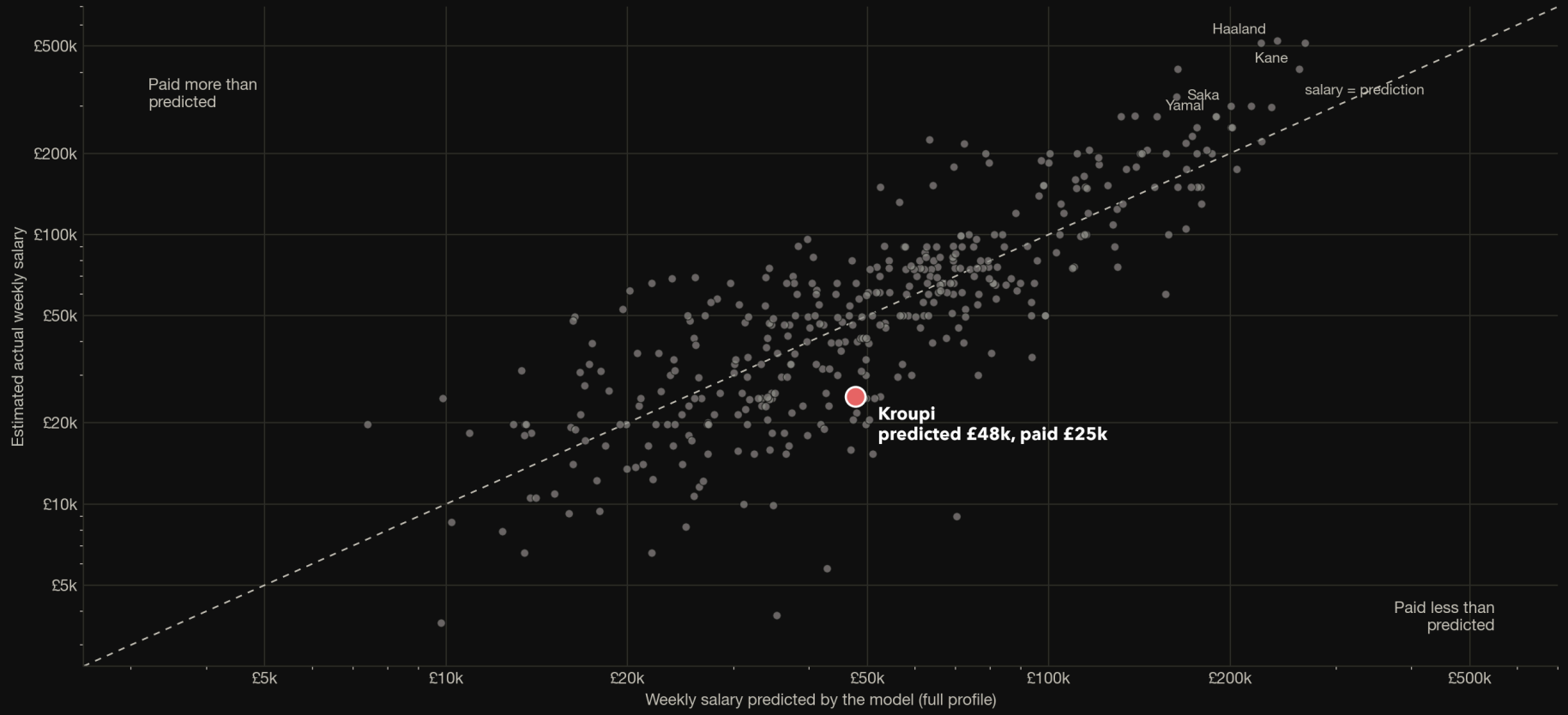
06

Pay equity within Bournemouth

Kroupi was Bournemouth's top scorer in the 2025-26 Premier League (13 goals), ahead of Semenyo (10 goals before his move to Manchester City), Tavernier (7) and Evanilson (6). Yet he only has the 22nd-highest salary in a squad of 28 players. Evanilson and Kluivert, the best-paid forwards (£80,000 a week), scored 8 goals between them. Rayan, who is the same age as Kroupi, earns twice as much and scored 5 goals.

By market standards, Kroupi should already earn almost twice as much

Actual salary vs. salary predicted by a machine learning model — 391 forwards and attacking midfielders from Europe's top 5 leagues. Log scales.



Model: linear regression on 2024-26 performance, age, experience, club and contract. Out-of-sample predictions. Salaries: SalaryLeaks. Stats: Understat.

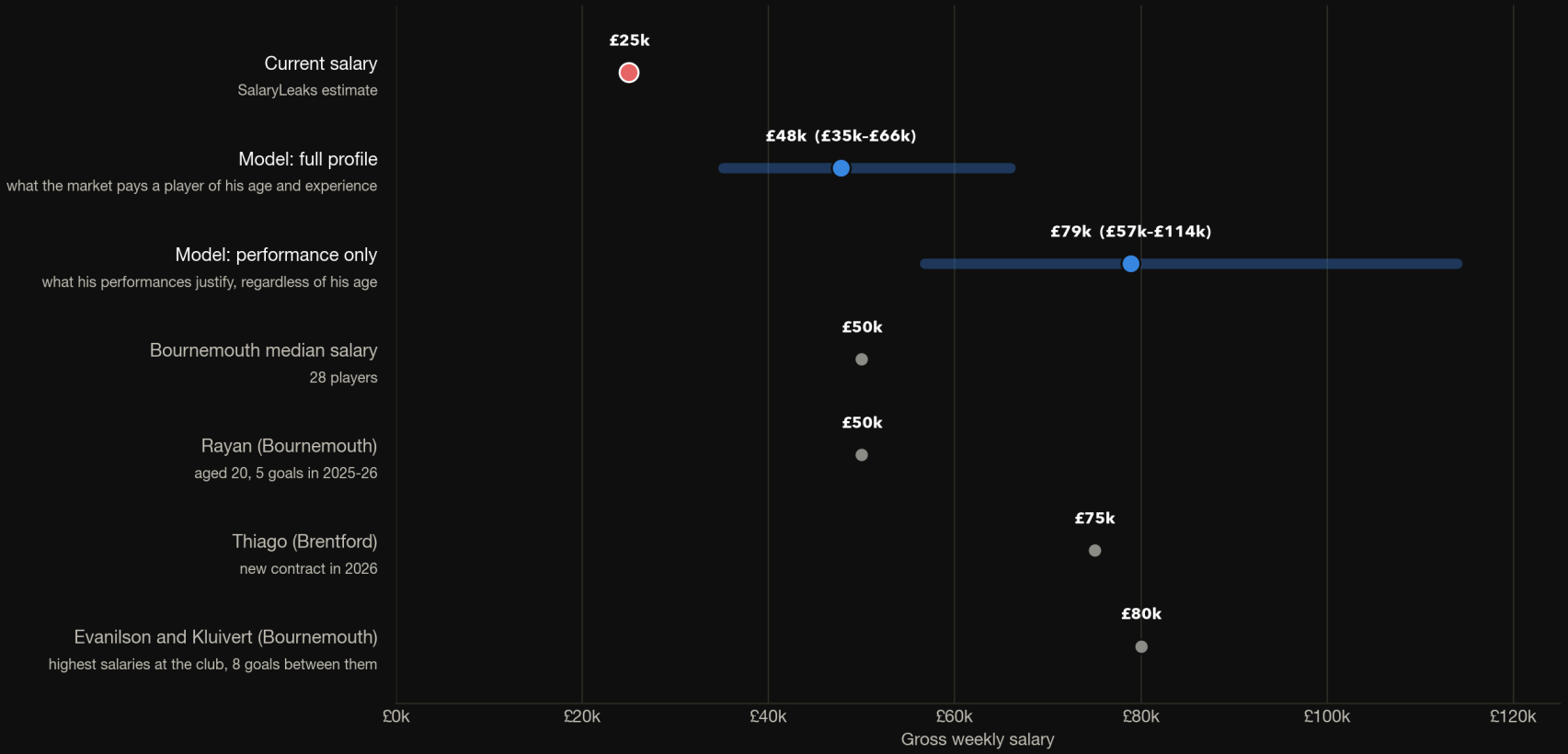
07

The salary model

To estimate objectively what Kroupi should be paid, we trained a machine learning model on 391 forwards and attacking midfielders from Europe's top 5 leagues. The model learns how the market pays a player based on his performances over two seasons, his age, his experience, the size of his club and the length of his contract. It explains around two-thirds of the differences in salary. Kroupi is among the players furthest below their predicted salary: the model estimates him at £48,000 a week, almost double his current salary.

The model puts his fair salary between £48,000 and £79,000 a week

Kroupi's current salary, machine learning model estimates and benchmark salaries. The light bar shows the range that contains half of the model's errors.



Salaries: SalaryLeaks estimates (September 2026). Model trained on 390 forwards from Europe's top 5 leagues, excluding Kroupi.

08

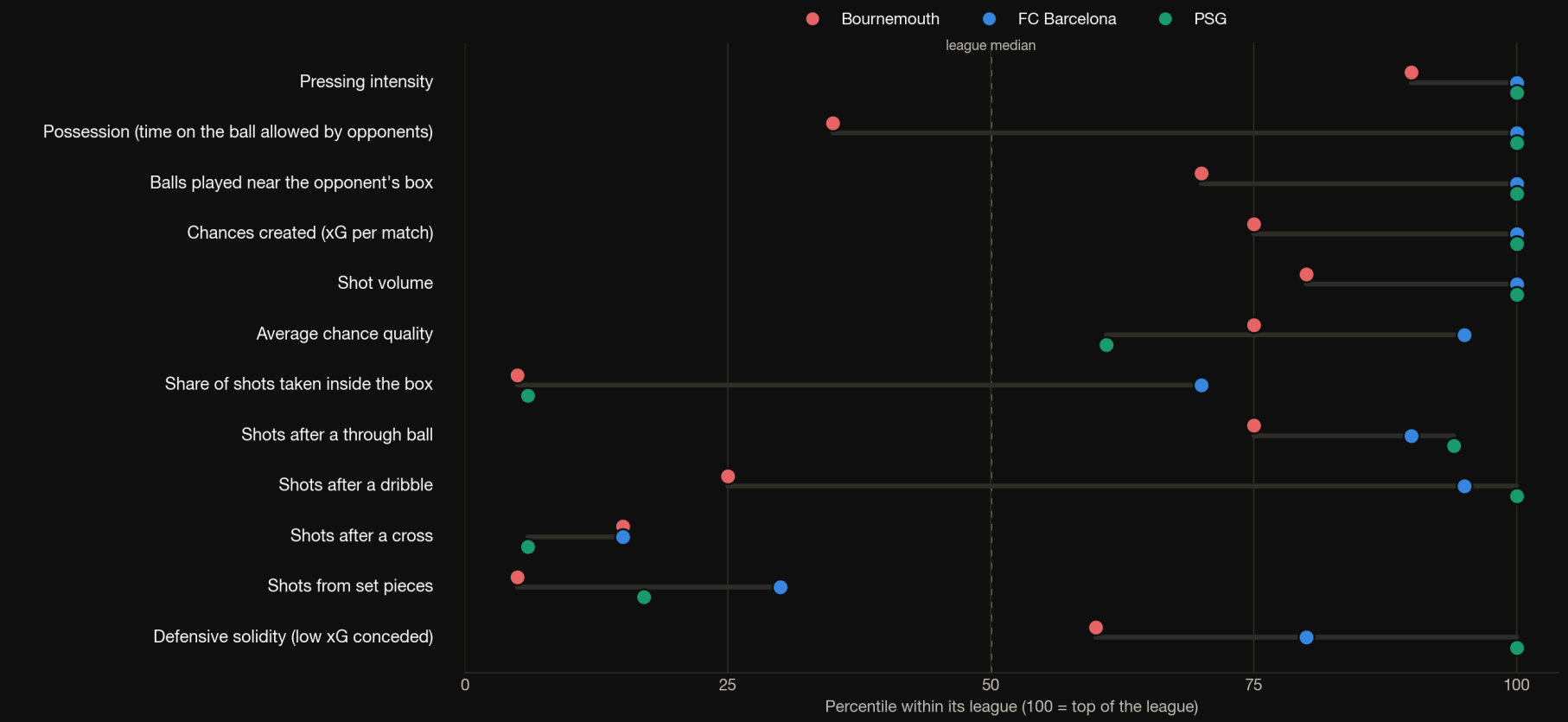
Pay rise range

Two readings of the model frame the negotiation. Based on a comparable profile, which takes his young age into account as the market does, his salary should be around £48,000 a week. Based on his performances alone, he justifies around £79,000, the level of Bournemouth's best-paid players. These two bounds match the club's benchmarks: the squad's median salary and Rayan, the same age, at £50,000, and Evanilson and Kluivert, the best-paid forwards, at £80,000 with 8 goals between them against 13 for Kroupi.

Limitations: the salaries used are public estimates, and the model is off by around 30% on average for a given player. It gives a reliable order of magnitude, not an exact figure.

A real change of style: from a pressing team to teams that keep the ball

2025-26 playing style of Bournemouth (Premier League), FC Barcelona (La Liga) and PSG (Ligue 1). Each team is ranked within its own league.



Pressing: PPDA (opponent passes allowed per defensive action). Possession: PPDA faced. Source: Understat.

09

Playing styles

Barça and PSG dominate their leagues on almost every indicator: possession, shot volume, chances created. Bournemouth press just as hard, but give the ball to the opponent more often and create fewer chances. For Kroupi, the change would be real: he would mostly face compact defences sitting in front of their box, with less space. Two things work in his favour. He is already used to very intense pressing, and both clubs create many chances from through balls, a type of action he knows well at Bournemouth. At PSG, shots often come from outside the box, as at Bournemouth; at Barça, they are taken closer to goal, where his finishing would pay off the most.

A finisher on par with Barça and PSG forwards, but less of a creator

2025-26 stats of the forwards used by each club this season (450 minutes minimum), compared with Kroupi's. 2025-26 league in brackets.



Numbers are harder to achieve in the Premier League than in La Liga or Ligue 1: at equal value, Kroupi's figures carry more weight. Source: Understat.

10

Against the Barça and PSG forwards

For non-penalty goals per 90 minutes, Kroupi is on a par with the forwards of both clubs: 2nd behind Raphinha at Barça, 3rd behind Ferran Torres and Dembélé at PSG. And he achieves these numbers in the Premier League, the most demanding league. On the other hand, he is the least creative player in each group (xA). At Barça, who lost both their centre-forwards this summer (Lewandowski and Ferran Torres), he would bring a finisher's profile the squad no longer has, supplied by creators such as Yamal and Raphinha. At PSG, he would be a second option up front behind Ferran Torres, complementing the creators Dembélé, Kvaratskhelia and Doué, and an impact substitute capable of scoring off the bench.

After a transfer, the model puts his salary between £68,000 and £131,000 a week

Kroupi's estimated salary on a 5-year contract, under both readings of the model (full profile and performance only), compared with the salaries of each club's forwards.



Salaries: SalaryLeaks estimates (September 2026), converted to pounds (£1 = €1.1658). Kroupi's current salary: £25k.

11

Salary after a transfer

On a five-year contract, the model estimates that Kroupi could command a salary of £68,000 to £131,000 a week at either club, three to five times his current salary. Even at the top of this range, he would remain the lowest-paid forward in the squad, on a par with Doué and Aklioucheé at PSG, and far from the £180,000 to £300,000 earned by the starters. That is an argument for the buying club: a finisher of this calibre on a reasonable salary.